

LANDO NORRIS

MOTORSPORT

It didn't take long for Formula One fans to observe that McLaren had a championship-winning car for the 2025 season.

For much of the year, it seemed as if Oscar Piastri, the Australian driver racing in only his second season, was going to be the one to turn that dream into reality for the orange team. But Lando Norris, Piastri's teammate who had been with McLaren since 2019, eventually shifted the momentum in his favour. The two drivers battled hard, leaving Red Bull's four-time defending champion Max Verstappen behind by a fair distance at one stage of the season.

However, the Dutchman found his mojo at the right time. A few strategic blunders from McLaren turned what looked like a procession into a thrilling three-way fight for the crown heading into the final race in Abu Dhabi.

Britain's Norris, who had perhaps failed to live up to his potential and been mocked as Lando 'No Wins', finally stayed calm under pressure. By finishing third under the floodlights at the Yas Marina Circuit — his 18th podium of the season — the 26-year-old beat Verstappen by two points to become the Drivers' World Champion. The triumph was the first for a McLaren driver since Lewis Hamilton in 2008. Piastri and Norris also ensured a comfortable march to the Constructors' Championship for their team.

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